LOGISTICIAN GUIDE TO CAREERS

Achieve your career goals and find stability, consistency, and dependability

16Personalities

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Introduction

Why Academic and Professional Development Matter to Logisticians

As incredibly purpose-driven individuals, Logisticians are likely to achieve a great deal of success in their chosen area (or areas) of expertise. Individuals with this personality type tend to receive accolades throughout both their academic and professional careers and are known to make stunning progress, given that clear rules and standards are in place. One of the key contributing factors to their achievement is their Observant trait, which allows Logisticians to analyze their surroundings and the expectations within them efficiently and effectively.

Logisticians focus on concrete facts and data and are extremely thorough, always checking their work and not assuming anything. Loyal and dutiful, they're respected for their accuracy, patience, and ability to concentrate – all traits that make them ideal students and employees.

Logisticians thrive on structure and stability and tend to gravitate toward academic programs and careers that are hierarchical in nature. They are likely to be drawn to (and excel at) any program or career that has a defined structure and focuses on facts, rules, and logistics. Potential areas of involvement for people with this personality type include law, business, medicine, military service, and engineering.

While they can function well as part of a team, they can also become easily frustrated by a perceived lack of dedication and focus that they may see in their colleagues. For this reason, many Logisticians prefer to work alone rather than rely on others who may not live up to their high

standards. They may also become rigid in school and work, resisting new methods or ideas in favor of preserving tradition and familiarity. And when in a position of seniority, whether as a manager in the workplace or a mentor to a younger student, Logisticians may struggle to connect on an emotional level with those counting on them.

In these pages, we'll discuss how Logisticians can overcome these challenges in their educational and professional careers. We'll also explore how people with this personality type can maximize their strengths in both the classroom and the boardroom, further solidifying the professional achievements that they work so hard for.

Curious about the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them? You can learn more here.

Academic Path

Logisticians learn best in an environment that applies the following three principles: practicality, duty, and tradition. As students, they are most comfortable in a traditional classroom with a clear sense of who is charge: who is the teacher and who is the learner. They respond best to traditional teaching methods, which might include lectures, drills, memorization, and testing. Logisticians value classes that lead to an applicable skill like business, math, drafting, or grammar.

How Logisticians Learn

Dutiful by nature, Logisticians seek paths of knowledge intended to help them uphold standards and practices. They scan, consciously or unconsciously, for information that supports how things "should" be. Logisticians gravitate toward subjects that promote cultural cohesiveness like civics, health, business/economy, or concrete technical subjects such as engineering. They pave their academic paths with courses that lead them in the most direct manner to stable jobs and careers. Their educational focus leads to attaining responsible adulthood.

To help them with this process, Logisticians follow whatever their unique communities and families convey as safe, stable, and permitted. It is enough that they know that the institutions prepare them to align with the expectations of their communities. Logisticians follow the path expected of them, and they may not realize that there are choices outside those expectations. Their worlds may be smaller because of this emphasis.

In turn, Logisticians don't find the abstract and philosophical very compelling. These pragmatists may be dismissive of courses involving the arts or philosophy for lacking, in their opinion, real-world application. If a debate or lecture goes on too long without landing on something useful, they may view the whole experience as wasteful. Logisticians tolerate such courses but only to honor requirements. They often apply themselves solely for a good grade and to fulfill the expectations of others. Real interest may be absent.

Logisticians are keen on their customary ways. It is very difficult to pull them away from their routines and areas of comfort – especially if their culture endorses them. Once Logisticians believe something, it's difficult to get them to accept alternative ideas. This commitment to their convictions makes it difficult for Logisticians to excel in courses that rely on imagination or creativity. They also shy away from general class discussions that entertain too many unconventional ideas. While they can be imaginative "inside the box," they do not like to wander outside of it.

Instructors can tap into Logisticians' strengths by providing them with a sense that they are doing what others expect of them and what is effective. They lose them if Logisticians perceive just a mental journey that leads to no practical end. A Logistician's optimal learning environment looks like this:

- A subject taught in a structured, linear fashion
- A training component with useful goals
- A model they can copy from and receive added coaching from if needed
- Ideas that connect the past to the present, with emphasis on the steadfast and stable or on proven and conventional ideas linked to a concrete purpose
- Constructive and objective feedback
- A teacher or teaching group that offers strong leadership and direction.

Logisticians, while naturally hard workers, find it difficult and uncomfortable to excel in environments where:

- Opinions carry too much weight
- Teachers allow things in the classroom to be too relaxed
- Goals are unspecified
- They are put on the spot or asked to give an opinion before they've learned the material. Logisticians need to be sure of themselves and like to be confident in their answer before they commit to it. They always appreciate a reasonable amount of time to check their footing before they respond.

Despite the above, Logisticians always work to deliver reliable results. They strive to be diligent students, no matter how uncomfortable they may feel. While it may be healthy for Logisticians to step outside of their comfort zones and relax a bit, they can rest easy knowing that the education system rewards students like them.

Balanced Learning Habits

Community-Based Pragmatism

Logisticians learn for the sake of their role as contributing members of society. These exacting types take pride in supporting the established order and will do what is necessary to keep things stable. Logisticians build upon their inner circle's foundation, try to fit into their culture, and help mend things where they can. They learn what is necessary to fill an existing gap or follow a path that those closest to them consider acceptable – pursuing an accounting degree because they come from a long line of accountants, for example.

They are effective individuals and follow an established path. Academically speaking, Logisticians remain stalwart knowing that whatever their learning comes to, it ultimately fulfills the needs of the community.

Strict Work Ethic

Logisticians subscribe to a rigorous work ethic. As a rule, not giving 100%, even if they dislike a subject, is unimaginable for them. Logisticians dislike the idea of not fulfilling their commitments and

obligations (even if they didn't ask for them) and they don't dismiss deadlines lightly. They will complete all necessary tasks with diligence.

Logisticians are respected students, and they commit to the time and effort needed to succeed. They are enthusiastic about hitting all the benchmarks and hitting them well. What they lack in an adventurous approach to learning, they make up for in hard work and will.

Unbalanced Learning Habits

Obligation Above All Considerations

Fulfilling expectations is of the utmost importance for Logisticians. They learn what they learn because they believe whatever lies at the end will guarantee a stable life and satisfy the expectations of their communities. Education is a utilitarian endeavor and, to that end, Logisticians seek a clear and purposeful path. The unknown can create significant anxiety and stress for these focused people. Taking an art course for the sake of enrichment would be difficult for the typical Logistician unless there is an obvious career endgame apparent. They are unlikely to see personal enrichment as a means of meeting their obligations.

If Logisticians know important others expect them to go to college, they do. Unfortunately, this can rob them of the opportunity to explore other options. College is not for everyone and non-college opportunities abound. They may pick a field of study and commit to it because they may see it as a fixed decision, refusing to change majors even if a better choice presents itself. They might remain trapped on outdated paths that once guaranteed success but no longer hold value.

Expectation Overload

When another student needs help or is struggling, Logisticians may feel obligated to assist. "No, I can't help you," is not a sentence that Logisticians utter easily. If they do decline to help out, they may follow up with "I can help find someone who can help you" or "I can give you an hour or so later." Rarely will a Logistician flat-out refuse. Logisticians, in part, expect themselves to not only grasp knowledge but to have an expert-like handle on it. This economic type may regard themselves as

squandering that gift if they don't employ it to guide others. There is a kind of stewardship involved.

Logisticians may have a tough time veering from paths dictated by loved ones and other authorities they respect and overload themselves with the expectations of others. Take, for example, a Logistician going to a specific university because it was their parent's alma mater rather than because they feel it's the best choice for them. There may be a push from somebody important in their lives to join a club, society, or team.

Logistician students' expectations can emerge from internalized demands developed over a lifetime of meeting others' expectations or from the real-time demands of family, community and even the school officials. They may lose a sense of deciding independently, apart from the blessings of others, past and present. Their inner voices may assume a tyrannical tone which is oblivious to the changes in a fluctuating world. Adhering to expectations may work for some Logisticians if they are not too exacting. However rigid and excessive expectations can potentially lead to disappointment and perhaps the loss of a sense of individuality.

Both obligations and expectations give something, and they take something. They give a sense of certainty, and there is rarely any doubt about how people should conduct their lives in their presence. But this certainty can come at a high price: A life lived more narrowly than needed, and experiences are missed along the way.

Rebalancing Learning Habits

Outside the Comfort Zone

The comfort zones constructed out of expectations and obligations may feel like safe places filled with certainty. However, when Logisticians break out of that zone – even just a little – they may find the following payoffs: increased productivity, expanded boundaries, and life changing experiences.

Making change is always daunting – especially when one doesn't know the outcome. The difficult nature of making significant changes keeps

Logisticians on well-worn roads paved with rules. It's not so much because of the effort that change entails. They don't mind hard work. However hard work differs from taking risks, and the unknown always holds risk. But often with great risk comes great reward.

To reduce the threat of risks, Logisticians might start by doing something small in a different way. They might discover a new spot to study, read a book on an unusual subject, or have coffee with a classmate who holds drastically different ideas. Baby steps work for both babies and smart adults.

By making changes little by little, Logisticians may at some point gather the courage to take a big leap – like going off to a university where they know no one, and the expectations of others are not a big part of the equation. There will always be plenty of obligations in life, but narrowing them to only those that are useful and relevant can bring all manner of freedom.

Putting Themselves First Occasionally

Logisticians will never surrender their sense of duty, nor should they. Despite some potential problems if responsibility becomes "overheated," a sense of duty is the foundation of many of their strengths. However, learning to temper that sense so that they control it, rather than it controlling them, can help them make decisions. There is no character flaw in prioritizing something simply because Logisticians desire it, and duty and desire can coexist if each balance the excesses of the other.

Whether it's tutoring someone else, choosing the right college or courses, or almost anything, it may help Logistician students to use the time-honored method of a two-column table. Label one column "My duty in/with (name situation)." Label the other "What I want out of (name situation)." Then fill in both columns with the relevant information until all thoughts about duty and desire have been exhausted. While this will not provide an automatic answer, it will likely give a clearer picture and allow both needs (duty and desire) to get a fair hearing.

Saying "no" can be a challenge for Logisticians, especially the younger among them. While they need no rationale to pursue a path once they

decide to do so – apart from their wanting it – making a case for their choices is a talent that they possess. There is no reason they shouldn't enlist it, and finding precedents to support their choices is almost second nature to them. A strong case can be hard to deny and can give Logisticians the confidence they need to move forward. It's easier to say "no" after presenting a solid case. "John Doe of XYZ Software company decided that college was not for him, and now he's a billionaire. I don't expect to be a billionaire, but the road to success isn't the same as used to be."

Logisticians in High School

Logisticians are the students who teachers love. They're hardworking, dedicated to doing well, and enjoy earning good grades. While other students are sulking and complaining about a life filled with teenage angst, Logisticians flourish in the structured learning environment that is high school.

The high school experience has evolved into more than just formal classes and lectures. Teens learn as many lessons in schoolyards and hallways as in the classroom, and clubs/sports help define the life directions of some. Exploring Logisticians' journey through high school would be incomplete without considering the social and extracurricular aspects.

Their peers may like Logisticians well enough, despite their being a little standoffish. Even as teens, they tend to take life seriously. They may not always fit into a more fun-loving high school scene and will avoid any teenage rebellion that descends into rule-breaking. As Introverts, they likely have a group of close like-minded friends to whom they are very loyal. But not being part of the wider high school social scene is fine for Logisticians. Popularity is not a primary goal. They play supporting roles: present and available to lend a hand. Even at this age, they may regard it as their duty to remind people of the prescribed ways of doing things.

In high school, Logisticians may benefit and yet be challenged by their inherent need to meet expectations. The challenges become clearer than ever. As teens, they must balance academic expectations, family pressures, social engagements and, unfortunately, hormones.

Balanced High School Learning Habits

Doing What Needs to Be Done

Logisticians do well in courses that promote administrative skills or skills they can apply to everyday life – home economics, for example. Subjects that entice them contain usable resources. However, not liking a course won't stop them from trying to succeed in it. They need not find a subject interesting or exciting to apply themselves. Logisticians trust a course is required for a reason, and it needs attention regardless of their personal feelings. They work from day one of high school until they graduate, working hard to meet all the requirements cast in front of them.

Balanced Logisticians tackle all necessary courses and meet reasonable expectations, but they also make sure to make time for or invest more in the subjects they genuinely enjoy. Every student, regardless of how serious they are, needs breaks and chances to explore personal interests, both structured and unstructured. Exploring friendships and dating is an important developmental aspect. Extracurricular activities, as well as simple "downtime," is essential to a balanced high school existence. It is unlikely that rest will get in the way of a young Logistician high school career.

Gaining Skills Through Support

When balanced Logisticians consider extracurricular activities, they gravitate toward those that support their paths, such as academic improvement, volunteering, or a career club. Such extracurricular activities could be for academic improvement, service to others, or a group dedicated to exploring a profession. Being practical, they join clubs that pad their resumes or their college applications. They are likely to stay out of the spotlight. Nonetheless, they may join the drama club or something of that nature if it represents building something more basic like school spirit, for example. However, often they take on a supportive role.

Logisticians do not enjoy the limelight and will be less likely than most to become leaders of any extracurricular organizations. If they join the drama club, they run the lights. If they join the debate club, they schedule the debates and fundraise for transportation. However, with

their attention to detail and protocol, they would do quite well in a leadership role. But it's more likely that If they do assume a leadership role, they will take a more auxiliary position like secretary or treasury.

Efficiency sometimes leads to reluctant leaders. Often Introverts who quietly perform well may find themselves thrust to the head of the line, and Logisticians shouldn't be surprised if their diligence sometimes places them in charge. Learning to adapt to situations not necessarily planned for or desired can provide an important lesson for them. With their diligence and high standards, they are likely to experience this often in life – management is a viable Logistician position. The flexibility needed to become a reluctant leader for the greater good might stand as an essential life lesson.

Unbalanced High School Learning Habits

Doing Only What's Expected

Logisticians are dutiful and committed, driven to meet the expectations placed upon their shoulders. While this often works in their favor, it can also turn against them. A Logistician, so focused on meeting requirements, may miss out on doing the things they want and enjoy.

Finding joy in learning is important to the academic process, and Logisticians may find that they have lost that joy somewhere along the way as they struggle to meet the expectations of others. For example, A Logistician who spends hours studying for a standardized test, but finds they have learned nothing outside the boundaries of getting the right answer on the test. Sure, they may know how to fill in the circle that best answers the conceptual question but realize that the skill is used nowhere else in life. There is no satisfaction apart from the brief and superficial experience of learning the specific test results.

Logisticians also run the risk of not discovering the things they like or enjoy, to begin with. They may never let themselves find their passion or specialize while they're still in high school, which could lead to steeper challenges later in work or higher education. There's nothing wrong with making progress according to the steps if they're careful not to allow themselves to become cog-like parts of a machine rather than self-expressive individuals.

Conformity is important to Logisticians. But they can begin to believe that they have no value due to their limited self-expression. Should they lack a means of expressing their individuality, they may develop a dull sense that they lack an exceptional purpose. This discomforting feeling can chip away at their perception of who they are. People like a sense that they provide something they are uniquely suited to provide. Humans dislike being "just another..." If left unbalanced, some Logisticians may face what Thoreau describes as the mass of men leading a life of quiet desperation. This feeling can start in high school.

Rigid Responsibility

One of the challenges Logisticians face in the high school classroom is that they possess a certain rigidity. Logisticians prefer defined structures and rules, so when faced with situations where "there is no right answer," as in philosophy or even the interpretation of statistics, they can struggle and become frustrated. They welcome unambiguous subjects.

Logisticians may have trouble with their fellow students in the classroom to an extent others may not. Since standards are such a dominant part of their motivation, other students disregarding rules can upset them. While they attend to the "letter of the law," their more flexible peers may not. There can be mutual frustration if they find themselves in a group of students who to cut corners or who don't attend conscientiously to the details of the project. For the conflict-averse Logistician, this may be stressful since they may not speak out or let others know their feelings. High school social arena can challenge student enough without having extra burdens added.

Being the hardworking students, Logisticians can be very hard on those who are slower or who don't carry their weight. They may not voice their judgment of others, but their attitudes may nonetheless show through. Logisticians aren't always aware of their emotional impact on others. If they develop an emotionally intelligent style that considers the feelings of others, they might find others react less defensively, and their relationships are likely to be more effective.

Too Diligent

Logisticians are likely to work from the first day of high school to the day they graduate. They strive to meet all the requirements put in front of them. Other students may slack off when the work becomes too predictable and easy or when they get toward the end of high school. Logisticians will not. They will continue to work to their highest level until they leave.

While that may sound like a dream come true to many educators, there is a dark side. Logisticians face enormous pressure to do the expected and may be inclined to sacrifice their joys and needs to meet certain standards. If success is determined to be a perfect grade average according to specific standards, then a Logistician may sacrifice their health (sleep, for example) to study.

Even if they don't feel well, Logisticians may be reluctant to take time off, as they see it as their duty to attend to school no matter what. This rarely bodes well, and Logisticians may find that their pursuit of diligence has left them worn out.

Rebalancing High School Learning Habits

Combining Patience with Assertiveness

Because teenage Logisticians abide by the rules and just plain "good" compared to their peers, they may hold frustration for the ruffians and the slackers of their generation. In their minds, they may be thinking "Why can't you just do the work?" or "Is it so hard for you to sit quietly in class and listen?"

In cases where someone is a true annoyance, a young Logistician might need to find ways to speak up. If such behaviors truly impede their progress or cause them distress than it becomes important to make feelings and thoughts known. Perhaps they may need to acknowledge that it is not their obligation to clean up the messes of others before they can act assertively. Fully believing their positions will help them make a more solid argument. Logisticians are the most honest type which supports being assertive since assertiveness involves telling the truth, just diplomatically.

Ways that a Logistician can deal with slacker classmates is to channel their pragmatic fairness, distribute the work, and hold others accountable with clear goals in mind. Below are tips that can help ease the process:

- Logisticians can take the slacker aside and communicate issues with them using "I feel..." phrases
- Be sure to stick to facts about the project you are working on: deadlines, page counts, requirements, etc.
- View the discussion as an exercise in honesty
- Offer a plan containing mini-goals to the project to keep the reformed slacker on track

Beyond Expectations

Young Logisticians operate well in areas where expectations are clear, and they work diligently to perform for those they care about – parents, mentors, friends. They place immense pressure on themselves to succeed and impress others. But there is a vast world of unique expression beyond the boundaries of cultural assumptions. Clinging so tightly to expectations can be both limiting and exhausting.

A consistently impressive performance according to standards is a good thing. But to grow, Logisticians also want to balance this by adding activities they enjoy. High school can provide an environment that allows students to figure out what they like, dislike and to begin building a sense of who they are. The high school years can start the journey of self-discovery that lasts a lifetime in various forms, and releasing the grip of expectations can strengthen the early stages of this discovery process.

So, meet goals, but also make time to find personal passions. Below are some questions to find out what that passion may be:

- As a child I thought of becoming _____.
- Most people don't know this about me, but I enjoy _____.
- I am the go-to person when my friends need help with _____.

Once there is some sense of what fills Logisticians in high school with a sense of purpose and enthusiasm, they can begin to explore them in practical ways. They might:

- Talk to the guidance counselor what activities correspond with the interest
- Join a club where there are activities and like-minded individuals
- Research the aspects of fulfilling one's passions
- Find someone in the community who might be willing to mentor them, even if it's not a professional consideration. (Guitar or ski instructor, for example.)

In high school, even steadfast Logisticians are likely to change their minds and their professional aspirations. Interests aren't necessarily permanent, particularly in adolescence. Logisticians may want exercise care and allow themselves to be reasonably flexible as they decide directions and passions.

Having a sharper image of who they are as a person, both through self-awareness and experience, Logisticians can start to decide, if they want to move into the workforce or to higher education.

Learning to Take Time Off When Needed

High school is difficult. With the added pressures of the future, parents, and extracurriculars, it can be exhausting to even the laziest of people and downright back-breaking to hardworking Logisticians.

While most teenagers would jump at the chance of staying at home, young Logisticians are reluctant to take a sick day. They would prefer taking some medicine, squaring their shoulders, and facing a day of exams, homework, and practices. Missing a day of school can cause a Logistician to feel nervous as they contemplate all the work they're falling behind on. Even though, technically, sick days are "allowed," there may be some sense that they are "dropping the ball." But perfect attendance isn't everything.

Still, health is more important than grades. Below are some ways that a Logistician can take a break or a sick day in peace.

- Ask the question: "If a friend was sick or wasn't feeling well, would I ask them to work through it?" If the answer is "no," then Logisticians should consider why they would ask it of themselves.
- Don't panic. Remember that whatever work missed during the break can be caught up on.
- Try not to think about school while out sick. Take the time to rest. The quicker a Logistician gets better, the quicker they can get back to school.
- Consider the larger consequences of bringing a germ into the classroom, and let a sense of responsibility rule. It isn't responsible to infect others with a cold or flu, for example. (Staying home if possible is highly recommended by the CDC and other health organizations.)

Work or College?

Go to college? Or go into the workforce? This fork-in-the-road decision plagues all young adults as they prepare to leave the swaddling comfort of high school. And while personality type is not the only factor that goes into making this choice, it can be very important variable.

Once higher education was the path one took to ensure security and success. For some, college is not within reach and may not even be desirable. Many are questioning the cost of education when compared to post-college income realities. Statistics often support college as the golden key to success, but statistics may not tell the whole story. Sometimes, the more personal story involves a friend who worked hard to earn an economics degree and now works as a bartender for tips. There are also many paths to differing careers and deciding which is best is dependent on the individuals and their aspirations. Online education is finding a more solid footing, and shorter while less expensive certification programs are often enough for many careers. The fortunate might slide into a family business, making a degree less consequential. Gap years are becoming increasingly popular and hold some advantages (as well as disadvantages). The question many Logisticians may have to ask is whether it's more practical to enter a trade early, find an alternative to traditional college, or just go the prescribed path of higher education on an assumed schedule. Sometimes the path

is well-defined, and sometimes the path is determined through difficult and unique decisions.

Logisticians will naturally prefer the well-defined path. They will rely heavily on community standards and family wishes. Nonetheless, the established nature of a direction doesn't necessarily make the direction the best choice. In some cases, Logisticians may once again need to challenge expectations in the interest of personal satisfaction.

In the interest of personal growth, it may be important for Logisticians to understand that they have choices available. Assuming no options may do them a disservice.

Balanced Decision Making

Understanding the Path

Many Logisticians have decided on the career or field they want to enter by the time high school graduation rolls around. They could go into the workforce rather than continue on to higher education. Many Logisticians do. Many go into college, usually as a result of being raised with that expectation. If they make that decision in a healthy way, then it rests on their self-knowledge and hearty pragmatism. The path they choose will both be practical and one where they find personal satisfaction.

If Logisticians feel college is a waste of time that leads nowhere, they may ditch higher education as an alternative altogether. Logisticians are efficient stewards. The idea of spending enormous amounts of money, time, and energy on something impractical is distasteful to them. Choosing higher education usually rests on two questions: "Is this a cost-effective choice?" and "Will I make a practical living after graduation?" All other considerations are extraneous and even considered a distraction to them. But considering their goals, the two questions are enough.

Checking Off the Requirements

If a Logistician needs a degree or a certification for their desired career, an accountant, lawyer, or engineer, for example, then they'll get one.

However, this type will keep practicality in mind as they search for an institution to provide said certification. They may go with the economical choice of trade school or community college for their degree over the pricier four-year university if they see that there is no difference.

Balanced Logisticians will want a school with a proven track record and look for examples of successful alumni doing the job they are aspiring toward. They seek precedents to assure them they are not putting time and effort into something that won't eventually pay off. Logisticians reject anything that lacks integrity, and diploma mills don't have a chance with them.

Positive Influences

The personal influence of family and people in the community strongly influences the directions Logisticians take, as it does all Sentinels, it can also go a level deeper for them. If they believe that there is some concrete code that they must live by, this will also influence them – even if it does not reflect the sensibility of their specific family or community. A national drive to increase the number of college graduates in the workforce may grab Logisticians' imaginations and convince them they need to go for more education for the good of society. For them, upholding such community or national standards for education may feel similar to joining a war effort.

It's easy to encourage Logisticians' decisions independently of their families and communities, but that may be short-sighted. Continuity found in communities can offer a stability unmatched by any other stabilizing force. And one shouldn't undervalue the experience of others. But balance would mean considering all outside influences while guarding the value of individual choices and preferences.

Unbalanced Decision Making

Risk of the Unknown

Logisticians ground themselves in the established. In turn, they fear change and the risk that goes with it. The idea of leaving what they know for an unknown future can be terrifying to Logisticians. They may assess a situation but assume anything new is risky, and find it lacking any assurances.

Fear of the unknown can force Logisticians into early work (say, the family business). They see it as a system that has proven results. They don't necessarily stay because they want to or because they like their work. Instead, the choice of the road less taken may seem too stressful, and they opt for the comfort of the familiar.

For Logisticians, the risk is they will not succeed or be successful in the ways they understand success. A risky path has no outcome that guarantees where they will end up. Before they start, they don't know if they will waste their resources pursuing something that means nothing in the end. And so they may choose safety and miss professional and personal opportunities by rejecting the unpredictability of pursuing higher education. Home and work may appear to be safe harbors.

Broadening One's Options

While balanced Logisticians want to be good stewards in choosing higher education, risk and sometimes cost is a part of growth. There is a difference between choosing prudently and choosing from limited options, and if a checklist becomes too rigid, the first can become the second. In their diligence, they may too quickly eliminate anything outside of overspecific criteria. As a result, they may miss opportunities that would benefit them.

It may be important to remember that college, especially when entered in young adulthood, offers more than a diploma. It is often the first exposure to independence. College students who move away from home learn to take care of themselves on a new level. Ideally, different institutions and programs encourage college students to think for themselves to different degrees. A checklist with a simple career focus may not cover these leaving, Logisticians to miss out on important life experiences.

Selecting for Others

Logisticians may choose to go to college because it's traditionally the path that their family or members of their community have taken. Even if a Logistician has a career in mind that doesn't need a college degree, they may attend anyway because they don't want to go against the grain or they just want to please others. Time, money, and enthusiasm can be

foolishly spent. On the other hand, some may come from communities where college is for "other people" and "the elite" – another limiting idea.

If Logisticians defer this decision solely to the opinions of others, it can be a point where Logisticians set up a more passive role in their own lives. Logisticians who do not include their independent opinions in the work or college decision may find themselves disappointed in themselves later. They may wish they had taken a stronger stand. Denying themselves this first major opportunity for deciding their unique direction in life may set a pattern that can be difficult to break.

Rebalancing Decision-Making

The Value of Risk

Taking a risk implies that an action has enough good potential the chance of failure is an acceptable gamble. But life's bigger rewards often come from taking reasonable risks. There is a certain degree of perfectionism among Logisticians and they may have it in their minds they can only be model students or model employees, and nothing less. The fear of taking a risk by entering the unknown is often linked to reputation and perfectionism. Consequently, those who unlink themselves from the goal of being perfect will take the risks needed for greater rewards. Choosing one's own path, despite the unknown and the risks on it, can be the same path that leads to the reward of personal satisfaction.

Unlinking from perfection and excessive risk avoidance:

- Make the unknown known. While this is, of course, impossible, a Logistician can get a little closer by talking to people who have had different experiences with entering college and making choices about work or college. If real-time conversations aren't possible, there are over three million responses to the YouTube query "Why I decided to go to college." Getting a sense of other people's experiences can be helpful.
- Voice concerns. Talk to a trusted someone who is likely to be objective. If still in high school, a guidance or college counselor may

be helpful. An older family member or family friend might be able to lend an ear and some of their experience. Those who listen may be able to offer solutions, examples from their decision making, or just provide an audience for venting.

- What's the worst that can happen? Make a two-column chart that explores the potential direction of a decision. In one column, list potential bad outcomes from the decision. In the second, list potential good outcomes from the decision. Give both a hearing. Such charts add clarity that may contribute to a more confident decision, but even if the chart doesn't reveal an obvious choice, it may still bring clarity.

Allowing Checklists to Evolve

The stumbling blocks of Logisticians' college checklist are likely to be limitations, whether the limitations are self-imposed or imposed by others. Expanding one's options is a creative act that reaches beyond assumptions and explores possibilities outside of the obvious. Logisticians are likely to protect their beliefs, and that's fine. Novel options might fit into the existing list and expand it. Or there may be completely different alternatives worth exploring. Either way, Logistician may decide they owe it to themselves to explore all practical options rather than assume none exist.

Take a moment to explore some options beyond the obvious:

- Start by identifying some choices and beliefs about the choices. What makes these options viable? Why are they choices? Make a list that is as comprehensive as possible.
- Set a timer for five minutes and create a Mind Map around the idea "Options and beliefs that are not on my list." Avoid judging and censoring and, instead, push the envelope as far as possible.
- Are their options worth exploring or beliefs that are useful? While there may not even be anything useful come from the Mind Map, hopefully, a sense that there are options available will emerge.

Finding Personal Value

One of Logisticians' best traits is that they are honest and work to

maintain stability. If they honor these traits, it may temper the influence the outside forces in their decision-making. While it is not their natural inclination, Logisticians may benefit from acknowledging that "To thine own self be true" is an important honesty. And while a type of stability can come from trusted external sources, like families and communities, they can change and, at times, be unpredictable. One's internal motivations are likely to be more consistent over time and being true to oneself means finding the answers within and then aligning them the best one can with society's standards. Logisticians are more likely to find their unique directions if they consult themselves first.

When choosing a direction after high school, a Logistician might want to explore the following questions with one- to two-sentence responses. Remain as concise as possible.

- When do you feel most engaged and enthusiastic?
- When did you overcome a difficult challenge successfully?
- When have you felt you were "in the zone?"
  - What were you doing at the time?
  - What were the principles you followed?
  - What did you do to reach your goal?
  - Did you feel personally satisfied by your accomplishment?
- Bearing in mind the challenges you face now (and possibly in the future), how can you build on what you know works?

Answers to these questions are likely to demonstrate your interests and passions. Unique interests and passions are what make a person an individual. The answers to the questions above provide a place to begin exploring the future. People who commit to something they believe in are likely produce more effectively. It's a fairly short step from discovering one's interests to developing an action plan designed to use them well. Logisticians relying on their interests to make decisions will likely experience more satisfaction throughout their lives.

Logisticians in College

Balanced College Life

Conscientious and Responsible

At first, college autonomy may disorient Logisticians a bit. For the first time in their lives, they are separate from their friends and family. They no longer have the structure they've come to depend on. This new independence places them wildly out of their elements. But this is likely temporary for the balanced Logistician. Consider that they spent their young lives looking for guideposts to direct them. That won't stop at the gates of higher education. Logisticians instinctively discover the established patterns that lead to success within a college environment, and these serve as new guideposts leading to another list of rules and standards to adopt. Soon the new routine is as comforting as the one from their childhoods. The baton of responsibility won't be dropped during this leg of the race either.

Logisticians' course choices in college are like the subjects they chose in high school. They excel in any detail-oriented work that needs careful administration and follows an established protocol: bookkeeping, business administration, engineering, and law, for example. For Logisticians, the subject isn't nearly as important as its application and purpose. This type likes the most direct path to the goal. They aren't attracted to less traditional courses, so they're unlikely to be found in a women's studies course or a survey of radical political movements class. Their interest is in more bedrock courses – perhaps something their parents took a generation earlier.

Logisticians read, or even study, their syllabi (unlike their peers) like a religious manual. They treat it as a welcomed structure to hang their college lives on. These responsible students avoid 8 AM classes if they know it's difficult for them to get up early. They strive to set themselves up for success. They turn in quality work exactly when it's due. In a sense, they will trade in the rules of high school for an updated set of rules for college. Unlike many other types, they will not flounder in their new environment, but instead, they will find the well-worn path that has worked for those who have gone before them, and they begin their journey on it.

Gathering the Tools for a Good Life

Some college students decide to party their four years away. That is far removed from the intentions of the healthy Logistician. Their main reason for choosing higher education is simple – to receive the certification or degree required to advance them toward their chosen career. They understand the path they are on and their interest in higher education involves carrying out a life plan.

College is an arena for personal experimentation for some, but Logisticians see it more as a field from which they can acquire the tools needed to build a stable and steady future. They utilize campus resources to the best of their abilities – career services, career fairs, their professors, and, of course, information. For them, college is all about forming strong foundations.

Unbalanced College Life

Lost in the Halls of Education

In high school, adults managed the lives of Logisticians, as the grown-ups carefully directed their activities. In college, the autonomy there presents a sudden radical shift from such micromanagement. The sudden freedom can overwhelm young adults. It's common for first-year students to experience feelings of depression and disorientation as they attempt to navigate the brave new world of higher education. It's reasonable to see why Logisticians may indeed feel like lost souls when pushed into this more unstructured environment.

In college, all work is in some sense independent work, and the guideposts and supports are less available. For many Logisticians, it may be the first time that nobody has told them what to do specifically. For those Logisticians who are perhaps too dependent on external structures, the early years of college can be painful. This freedom (or abandonment, depending on the point of view) can be disconcerting to Logisticians who have overly relied on very fixed rules and established structures. They hate to feel ineffective, and a difficult start in college may be indistinguishable from that feeling. If they are not careful, it might set the tone for the rest of their time there.

Overload and Drudgery

In their desire to set solid foundations while in college, it is a natural for Logisticians to overload themselves. Whether it is from the pressures of the school's requirements or the expectations they pile on themselves, sooner or later, Logisticians typically deal with the question of overload. Those who have not learned the art of self-care in the midst of responsible behavior become themselves overwhelmed and stressed.

In high school, Logisticians' ability to stress themselves out may not have been as serious due to smaller workloads and fewer expectations. In college, however, Logisticians have free rein to express their perfectionism within their chosen courses and activities. They will also add stress to their lives by pushing for too much detail and will make excessive demands of themselves. These demands may look like the following:

- Not cutting themselves slack when they make mistakes;
- Pushing themselves too hard to achieve/maintain high grades;
- Pushing themselves too hard to meet external expectations;

As the weight becomes heavier and heavier, Logisticians continue to smile dutifully even as they begin to falter under pressure. Despite the compliant smile, the stress can erode not only their effectiveness but also their morale. They are likely to push through and succeed anyway. Success drenched in stress may not make the experience any less miserable for them. Instead of a rewarding experience, the college years can soon represent drudgery and regret.

Rebalancing College Life

Finding Their Way

Logisticians tend to seek out the structure they need and find examples of success to use as a precedent to follow. Finding their way may come naturally. However, a lot depends on their maturity level. Younger Logisticians may need more help than older Logisticians entering college. It may be difficult for this stoic type to ask for help when they need it.

If Logisticians find themselves stressed out by the lack of structure at college, they may want to make alliances with other students, preferably more experienced scholars. Some colleges offer mentoring programs where older students take new students under their wings. Joining campus organizations can also be a place to see how others navigate the autonomy of higher education. Logisticians might figure it out for themselves, some quicker than others, but they respect the proven path and getting to know others can help them discover the way. Indulging their Introverted tendencies and isolating themselves is likely not helpful in adjusting to a new life.

Reshaping Unreasonable Expectations

While Logisticians in high school had issues with taking a break, Logisticians in college may be unwilling to deal with the root of their stress: trying to meet unreasonable expectations. Their expectations might include maintaining a perfect grade point average while taking a full course load of rigorous classes *and* having a part-time job. Any objective assessment would call their schedule an unrealistic burden.

The first step to dealing with Logisticians' heavy expectations is to have them acknowledge they've created an unreasonable situation for themselves. One simple way to check that out is to ask: "Would I ask someone else to do all these things? Would I wish this schedule on my best friend?" While they may project their expectations onto others at first, their more rational side is likely to give an objective answer. (The correct answer is that the schedule is a soul-sapping burden which shouldn't be wished on anybody.) A realistic assessment is an important step in goal-setting.

Logisticians suffer in silence because they believe they should be able to handle everything expected of them. They view meeting expectations, no matter how unreasonable, as a duty. And so, they grit their teeth and bare the pain. However, to be a better-rounded person, it is necessary to understand that it's okay not to be okay sometimes. Pain, discomfort, and emotional stress are early warning systems that alert people to change the course or to suffer further insult to their well-being. Logisticians help themselves when they learn to treat their different feelings with respect and heed the information they provide.

Becoming literate in the language of one's own feelings can be as simple as raising awareness. One method involves setting a random alarm on one's phone or watch to go off at unexpected intervals. When the alarm sounds, make a note somewhere with the answers to two questions:

1. What is my current feeling?
2. What is the feeling telling me? Perhaps the feeling is discouraged, and it's foreshadowing an impossible afternoon filled with too many arduous tasks.

A lot of times dutiful people learn to ignore their feelings. Bringing them back into the conversation can help Logisticians deal better with unreasonable expectations and consider their own well-being more often.

Lifelong Learning

Balanced Lifelong Learning

For Logisticians, "learning" is very much about gaining real-world-applicable skills. They gather what they need to create and maintain a stable life. They hope to serve the people and organizations they respect in an improved way. Logisticians will continue to learn if it supports the life they hope to build.

Mature Logisticians recognize that there is knowledge outside of the scope of their experience and educations. To become better at what they do and are, they understand that they may need to increase their knowledge from time to time. There may be occasional reluctance because learning means change and that isn't always comfortable for Logistician. But with experience comes the understanding that growth takes place outside of one's comfort zone.

Having Time to Learn

Logisticians may find that when they get older, their obligations will grow and time becomes a precious commodity. It's easy for this type to become completely swept up in maintaining that which they have built. Finding time to learn something, even something that has a large benefit may become challenging. Making time to become "better" may seem like a luxury.

Balanced Logisticians will carve out time in their busy lives to pursue new information or skills that will make them more effective and perhaps their lives more enjoyable as well. While work and personal obligations are important, there will find room to incorporate new skills into their everyday routine. A non-cook learning to produce nutritious meals at home from scratch may need to take some time out of their routines to learn the skills, but the health benefits and enjoyment factor can make it all worth it.

Learning New Skills to Complement Old Lives

Logisticians don't learn new things for the sake of novelty, but because they can apply it to the practical aspects of their lives. They take the time to look at the life they have and wonder how they can enrich it for both themselves and the people around them.

This preference for practical learning can manifest itself in pursuits like learning more about automobiles so they can handle minor car issues on their own. Or, perhaps if they picked up carpentry they could create simple furniture pieces (that they can then pass on to their children). They might learn how to garden and grow a vegetable patch, the produce of which they can use in the healthy meals they learned to cook.

Enrichment learning may seem like "extra" to many busy Logisticians, but the balanced of the type will know that such pursuits add texture and dimension to lives without interfering with effectiveness. It's not about novelty or an attempt to tamp down boredom. It's about taking a good life and making it even better.

Unbalanced Lifelong Learning

No Time for Learning

Logisticians who decide they are too busy to learn something new may be robbing themselves of personal and professional growth. In this changing world, neglecting professional development can mean the loss of a promotion or even a job. Losing a job would certainly solve the problem of being too busy.

As far as personal growth, one of the problems that Logisticians often face as they go through life is the vague sense that they are just cogs in a machine. Some lose their sense of individuality and, consequently, personal value. Learning the right things can help them distinguish themselves from others and give them a stronger sense of their unique selfhood.

Settling and Stagnation

Logisticians will often choose contentment and reject change as a threat to that contentment. When deciding on a direction in life, Logisticians may decide against something new as a way of leaving "well enough alone." Unless there is a very compelling reason to take a course or to pursue a new direction in learning, they may forego it to protect that which they know. What others see as a type of stagnation, Logisticians may see as a form of maintenance. The may not see the value of disrupting their routine by learning to grow a garden. There is always the supermarket as it has been for years.

The world as a person knows it is predictable. Once new knowledge is allowed in, it can become less so. Logisticians may find shaking up their predictable lives with new information difficult and perhaps even threatening.

If the level of contentment is high enough, a Logistician might believe that there is nothing else of value for them to learn. They may question what they need to add to the life they already respect and value. Logisticians are protective of that life, and too much new information may prove to be more of a threat than a benefit. And, consequently, they may miss out on so much.

Rebalancing Lifelong Learning

Finding Time to Learn

Time may be the biggest obstacle in any Logistician's academic development with other obligations distracting them from learning. However, it is important for a Logistician to carve out time and to put themselves first on occasion. Creating space for self-care can help

lower stress and improve a Logistician's overall mood. Taking time to grow in stimulating ways can be a healthy part of a stress management program.

They can begin by committing at least an hour a day to learn or practice a skill they enjoy. Logisticians can incorporate the hour into their routine. Take, for example, a Logistician who likes to relax and watch television for a couple of hours at night. They can also use that time to practice knitting or sewing (it may take an additional hour or two to learn the technique). College level courses are now streamed through many devices and can be entertaining – learning and relaxation available in one place. Crafty people teach artistic and artisan skills throughout YouTube. It's a miraculous age for pursuing lifelong learning, and it is rare that an hour or so can't be found to enlarge a life. There are many ways for the willing individual to fit learning and growth into even the busiest day.

There can also be a social aspect to learning. There can be fun, and the right classes might involve meeting new people and making it well worth finding an hour a week to learn. Single Logisticians may be especially interested in this aspect. Combining one's social life with learning (or vice-versa) can deliver two wonderful things in one package.

Varying the Routine

Being "set in your ways" isn't necessarily a bad thing. However, there's always room for improving upon an existing routine. A Logistician can begin this by picking a relatively mundane task – take, for example, a walk. Rather than taking the same path every day, a Logistician can choose a different path every other week. A walk through on a forest trail, a walk through the city, a different route through the neighborhood. Even a small variation can loosen up the tight grip existing routine has on a life and begin to open new vistas of learning.

Based on their small excursions, a Logistician can then adjust their routine based on what they liked or disliked. They can decide in the end not to change their old routine at all if that's what suits them better. Or they apply this exploratory spirit to other parts of their lives. There is always a new experience to have and new things to learn. It doesn't have to be earth-shaking or life-changing. Learning can benefit a life without being too disruptive.

However, once a Logistician discovers that learning something new is not likely to shatter their lives, they might choose to stretch their experience even more. They may find the benefit of continued learning far outweighs any risk or problems.

Conclusion

Following Their Own Path

Learning comes through seeking and experiencing the unfamiliar, resulting in a constantly changing state – usually in the form of improvement. For Logisticians who deeply value predictability, such expansion can understandably stressful, but no less wonderful. Their desire to build beneficial structure leads them to embrace sensible and useful ideals such as education, even if it demands that such construction is ongoing. Logisticians who prioritize advancing their minds can accept that their goals, methods, and determination can be a supportive structure, but knowledge itself may be more fluid. With a balanced approach, figuring out their own best way to learn need not feel like chaos, nor limit what they can learn.

And, if this type finds themselves overloaded, they can reach for the structures that help them stabilize, remembering the ultimate reasons for what they're doing. An academic plan is a great reason to persevere, but it should not feel like a straitjacket. Maintaining fair expectations for themselves isn't only about drive, it means granting themselves forgiveness for their occasional stumbles. No one is perfect, and while it's good for Logisticians to walk a firm path when it advances who they may become, education shouldn't feel like drudgery. It's important for Logisticians to design a system of learning in which they're able to appreciate every moment of what they accomplish.

Professional Development

Throughout this chapter, we discuss how Logisticians can understand their personality traits to maintain balance and excel in their professional development. In addition to their positive traits, we discuss what may cause them to become frustrated and to feel unbalanced in these areas. Finally, we provide insights into how they can utilize their strengths to regain their balance and thrive in their career and in their professional growth. Ultimately, we hope that this guide gives Logisticians both the understanding and the tools needed to pursue their chosen career path.

While reading this chapter, you may also find it helpful to read the *Logistician Guide to Personal Growth*. It provides in-depth techniques on how to determine personal goals as well as how to develop achievable goals. This development is an important step to take before searching for a career. It is also incredibly useful for Logisticians who may be unhappy with their current career. Defining what it is that they truly value and would like to achieve can make switching careers not only less intimidating but also exciting, once they have found the proper motivation.

Dutiful and Meticulous

Logistician personalities are known for their ability to process an extraordinary number of facts, categorize them, and use that knowledge to point out various discrepancies. Their dependability and patience make them irreplaceable in situations where other types are either unable or unwilling to take on difficult responsibilities. These skills can be tremendously valuable in the right career path – people with

this personality type are great at jobs that require good administrative skills, thoroughness, and the ability to notice even the tiniest details. Many Logisticians can be found among auditors, data analysts, medics, and accountants.

People with this personality type put facts and duties above just about everything else. Consequently, the best Logistician careers reward meticulousness and dedication. Logisticians have very high standards, especially when it comes to their own work. When balanced, they keep these expectations realistic and reasonable while still upholding their high standards. Logisticians are likely to put an extraordinary amount of effort into getting the job done – even when they know that their colleagues or managers are unlikely to notice or recognize their efforts.

Ideal Inspectors

Regardless of their field, Logisticians are inspectors at heart. Nothing fascinates them more than noticing a discrepancy and then tracing it back to its source, thus restoring order. People with this personality type are factual, no-nonsense thinkers, able to obtain and organize an extraordinary amount of information using their innate investigative skills. Logisticians are the ultimate inspectors for a reason – their keen eye for detail and quiet determination give them a distinct advantage over other personality types when it comes to data analysis.

Logisticians are hardworking, patient individuals, so they are likely to do relatively well in many fields, but none will satisfy them as much as a logistical role. Specific roles that satisfy this need to delve into details and organize them are detective work, private investigation, forensic auditing, and legal research. Any career where they are able to dig deep for facts and organize them to make sense of a situation will be deeply rewarding.

Focused on External Expectations

Problems may arise for Logisticians when they rely only on family or societal expectations to tell them which career they should pursue. They ignore their own thoughts and feelings about what the best path may be. When a career is not chosen based on personal desire, it is much more difficult to find it fulfilling or engaging. A Logistician may choose to pursue a career in engineering because a parent was in that

field and may expect them to "follow in their footsteps." Or, they may choose to go into medicine because they know the profession to be well-paying and jobs to be plentiful. If these fields are truly in line with their skills and desires, these options are perfectly acceptable. If not, they can be an unnecessary burden that holds Logisticians back from work they'd be happier – and more effective – in.

Structure and stability are certainly worthwhile characteristics to seek in a future career. However, the desire for these "safe" careers may lead Logisticians to accept a less compatible job over one that would have been more in line with their personal values. Choosing a profession because it is expected or pays well is unwise. An unsatisfying job can make life miserable, which ultimately affects productivity, family life, and anything else that Logisticians may value. It's better to find work that fits their values and goals than to make themselves fit into a career that is unfulfilling.

Struggle with Social Intelligence

Logisticians may also face challenges in their workplace relationships. People with this personality type rarely care about making friends in the office, seeing their work and duties as far more important. Such an attitude is not really surprising – after all, this is their modus operandi in many other areas of their life. However, difficulties in developing casual relationships at work can stifle professional development and result in missed opportunities, both personal and professional.

Additionally, Logisticians may have unrealistic expectations, both of themselves and others. When these expectations are not met, respect is lost, and the possibility of further collaboration is greatly decreased. It doesn't take much for Logisticians to find a colleague incapable of performing their duties effectively. This mentality can create issues for Logisticians working on teams as their coworkers will become frustrated by their stubborn focus on rules over diplomacy, innovation, or rapid action.

Finding Their Own Path

It is quite easy for Logisticians to become caught up in the expectations of those in authority, whether it is their parents, teachers, or bosses.

Following the rules comes naturally to people with this personality type, and this can be to their detriment when it comes to finding a satisfying career. While there is nothing wrong with wanting to respect their parents' wishes or work in a field that pays well, these factors should not come at the expense of doing something that they truly want to do. Financial security, status, and respect are important, but achieving personal (rather than societal) goals, such as a comfortable work/life balance or free time for hobbies, is equally important.

Determining what career would be the most fulfilling may seem idealistic, but Logisticians who do find themselves much more satisfied with their choice of career. Not taking the time to determine what they truly want to do, rather than just what others expect them to do, will likely result in periods of self-doubt and questioning at some point. Determining their personal values and future goals before they choose a career path is the best way to ensure that their job provides both stability and satisfaction.

Increase Social Intelligence

It is important not to underestimate the importance of what are generally called "people skills." Social intelligence is just as important in the workplace, if not more so, than experience or cognitive intelligence. Many Logisticians dismiss this idea, seeing little value in things like small talk and socializing, but that misses the bigger picture. One of the most important aspects of social intelligence in the workplace is the understanding of others' methods and behaviors.

For example, Logisticians are often disappointed by the recklessness or head-in-the-clouds attitude of some people they come in contact with. However, this does not mean that there is no point in learning more about what drives and motivates other members of society, or simply the workplace. They do not necessarily have to enjoy that or seek deeper meaning in such exercises, but having these skills can give them a tremendous advantage both at work and elsewhere. Sometimes defusing a difficult stakeholder can get someone much further than finding that annoying little mistake in the accounting journal.

Logisticians will need to make an effort to establish a connection and some level of mutual trust with others of varying personality types.

Going to lunch with a group of colleagues, joining a project or committee they wouldn't have normally considered, or even just asking a coworker about their weekend are all ways to build relationships. Even virtual employees can interact with colleagues via chat tools or virtual clubs, committees, or organizations. Positive relationships are not only helpful when seeking advancement, they can provide a surprising amount of personal satisfaction as well. Additionally, improving their relationships in the workplace improves their social intelligence and the subsequent leadership skills necessary to excel in a management position.

Jobs and Skill Sets

Let's look at some specific jobs that Logisticians may find fit them best. We do not try to offer a full list of professions. That would be impossible, and the list would grow daily. Instead, we offer a sampling of jobs that are consistent with Logistician personality traits, with added explanations of what makes them suitable. Logisticians can use this to create guidelines when thinking about their own career goals.

For those who are already employed, this may serve as a confirmation or an explanation for why a particular job is satisfying or unsatisfying. We do not presume this to be a firm prescription of what each person must do to be successful or happy. Rather, we hope that it will provide some insight for anyone in the process of finding or changing careers.

Business and Law

Having what's needed at the right time and place is the heart and soul of logistics and management. There is perhaps no better personality type than a Logistician for carrying out this important work. Logisticians

are sticklers for details and getting things right and are more likely than others to catch a discrepancy. Any analysis a Logistician makes will be fact-based and according to a known set of standards, so accuracy is assured.

Logisticians are happiest when working alone and will probably do just fine in a cubicle with a pile of spreadsheets or a computer, though working with small, focused, competent and professional teams can be equally satisfying. Additionally, careers in law, especially legal research, are likely to speak to Logisticians' desire to uphold rules and promote fairness. Jobs that utilize these qualities might include:

- Clerical work
- Inventory management
- Accounting or auditing
- Asset manager
- Data analyst
- Economist
- Actuary
- Attorney
- Detective
- Paralegal/Legal Researcher

Health Care

At their core, most Sentinels feel the need to take care of others in tangible and practical ways, and Logisticians are no different. This makes them excellent candidates for health-care work. Their traits equip them to care for patients especially when considering their attention to detail and their ability to organize and to meet goals.

Logistician health workers typically do not tolerate negligence or mistakes, and this is invaluable in a medical setting. Logisticians' bedside manner may not be ideal, but they will be kind enough and do

a commendable job especially when it comes to administering the right care at the right time. Jobs that may fit them well include:

- Family physician
- Specialty physician
- Nurse
- Dentist
- Phlebotomist
- Pharmacist
- Medical secretary
- Surgeon or surgical technician
- Speech-language pathologist

Science, Technology, Engineering, and Math

The STEM (science, technology, engineering, and math) fields are notoriously data driven, and Logisticians are perfectly suited for this type of work. Attention to detail, skills in data analysis, and a respect for structure are vital for these occupations, which often employ the scientific method. Engaging in stringent methodology and upholding the rigorous standards necessary in science and engineering fields is something Logisticians can truly excel at.

From designing and building a mechanical component to gathering and analyzing medical data for research purposes, Logisticians' ability to focus on seemingly mundane details is perfectly suited to this type of work. This is also perhaps the best personality type for collecting and organizing raw data for research projects at universities as well as the private sector. Some examples of STEM jobs suitable for Logisticians might include:

- Mechanic
- Chemist
- Geologist

- Medical researcher
- Military science
- Teacher of mathematics, engineering or science
- Engineering (civil, mechanical, environmental, mining, nuclear, etc.)
- IT administration
- Academic researcher (particularly collecting and organizing data)

What Makes a Job Unsuitable for Logisticians?

In modern society, people not only spend a great deal of time at work, but they also tend to want their work to be fulfilling. A career that is not suitable for one's personality type can lead to extraordinary difficulties in achieving happiness or fulfillment career-wise. The following paragraphs contain some characteristics of the type of jobs that may not be suitable for Logisticians.

Loose Structure

Logisticians need a strong sense of structure to feel at ease in their positions. They respect the authority of the boss, the reliability of their colleagues or subordinates, and the sovereignty of time-honored rules. A clear hierarchy and chain of command at a job provides Logisticians with a sense that there is a solid foundation holding everything up.

Logisticians don't like improvised action or taking unproven, unstable paths. They need a sense that they have a firm foothold in a company, but they will not have that sense if the ground is continuously shifting. If the company culture is too forgiving of mistakes, even if they are the result of useful risks, or where standards constantly are changing, Logisticians may feel out of place. Logistician workers demand a tight ship.

Additionally, Logisticians do not fare well in situations where they need to do unfamiliar work under time pressures. People with this personality type are generally objective and able to keep a cool head in critical situations, but they feel far more comfortable when they have

enough time to assess a situation and make an informed decision. Logisticians have an excellent set of leadership skills lurking beneath the surface, especially if they work to develop their social skills, but being in "emergency mode" can exhaust them very quickly. Unlike Explorers, Logisticians in general are more suited to be administrators than frontline executors.

Lack of Recognition

Logisticians enjoy others recognizing the work they do and, while they may not be obvious about it, others noticing their efforts energizes them. Logisticians may seem indifferent to the attention, but they do need some positive acknowledgment for their undertakings. It could be a pay raise or bonus or a letter of recognition, but they need a signal that they are appreciated.

A lack of recognition could have the opposite effect on Logisticians and create frustration. However, people with this personality type are unlikely to advertise their accomplishments and may instead employ passive-aggressive behaviors. It may pay off for Logisticians to ensure that the culture of the business recognizes hard work before they apply, especially regarding the behind-the-scenes work that they are often drawn to. This type of recognition is often done through performance-based raises and structured advancement opportunities, but can be as simple as a manager who delivers a personal thank you for meeting specific challenges.

Significant Social Interaction

Logisticians may have trouble engaging with others in a positive, empathetic way and could struggle when forced to make small talk or engage with others in an empathetic way. Logisticians are not uncaring, they are simply more interested in doing work at the workplace and avoiding personal and emotional issues. This can be perceived as a lack of interest in others which may result in friction with colleagues and customers alike.

Logisticians tend to do much better as solitary workers or on small focused teams. But jobs with too much contact with colleagues or customers, such as Human Resources or Sales, may prove exhausting

for Logisticians. A career that requires too much social interaction can leave little energy for people with this personality type leading to burnout, decreased effectiveness, and the stresses of work spilling over into their home life.

Self-Employment

We live in the age of possibilities, and selling time to a corporation is not the only way to generate income. The notion of self-employment can be quite scary – however, job security and guaranteed prospects are a thing of the past, with the exception of a few fields such as accounting or medicine. Consequently, being self-employed may be a more secure and viable option, which also comes with a range of other benefits, such as the ability to plan one's time, to see tangible results of one's work from start to finish, and to work independently. Logisticians are hardworking, diligent individuals, and their ability to pay attention to even mundane details is very valuable for self-employment.

Suitable Jobs for Self-Employed Logisticians

Hobbies

One of the most effective ways for Logisticians to become self-employed is to find a hobby that they could potentially turn into a source of income. This approach is particularly effective for Logisticians, who tend to focus on becoming as proficient at their hobbies as they are at their careers. The actual earnings do not really matter that much in the beginning. What matters is the chance to do something that is truly exciting and inspiring. Self-employment opportunities that can be generated from hobbies include:

- Blogging about a specific hobby or an existing career (technical or nontechnical)
- Creating handmade goods (can provide via local stores/craft fairs or via online vendors like Etsy)
- Providing home improvement services
- Computer repair and data recovery

- Landscaping or lawn care
- Professional organizer (no, really!)

Out-of-the-Office Jobs

Another popular option for Logisticians looking to become self-employed is to take their current career and turn it into an opportunity for self-employment. Many careers can be done without being operated by a large company or corporation. With knowledge and job experience from a current or previous job, Logisticians who decide to pursue this option will have an easier time finding potential clients. Examples of careers that can be turned into self-employment opportunities include:

- Accounting or bookkeeping
- Home medical care
- Data entry
- Paralegal/Legal secretary
- Consultant
- Private investigator
- Medical transcriptionist
- Virtual assistant

Unsuitable Jobs for Self-Employed Logisticians

There are many jobs today that are marketed at people who wish to work for themselves that would not be a good fit for Logisticians. Although many would enjoy being self-employed, most individuals with this personality type are not interested in becoming an entrepreneur, a role practically defined by high-profile salesmanship and aggressive self-promotion. Self-employment should, ultimately, provide the type of balance that they desire. Any job that requires significant social interaction or high-pressure sales techniques will quickly exhaust Logisticians. A few specific examples of jobs that may be unsuitable for this type include:

- Multilevel marketing jobs (such as selling makeup, clothing, or household goods)
- Home daycare
- Driver for a ride-sharing service
- Medical billing
- Door-to-door sales

Professional Development in the Workplace

Once they have found an ideal career, Logisticians will face the next hurdle in their professional development. Professional development isn't complicated: it's a combination of personal awareness and changes in behavior following this awareness that take place along one's career path. Understanding one's strengths, weaknesses, values, and goals is necessary in order to become the best employee, manager, or volunteer possible.

Logisticians do not necessarily need a "special" environment to make their work satisfying. And, while they truly enjoy working behind the scenes, they make excellent managers and leaders as well. The real key to making sure that Logisticians succeed in any role is understanding themselves and knowing their goals.

The following paragraphs will discuss the strengths and weaknesses that Logisticians may have to work with in each of their workplace roles to promote their own professional (and personal) development. Following that, we will discuss the potential issues and opportunities that Logisticians may face when dealing with colleagues in each of the different personality type roles (Analyst, Diplomat, Sentinel and Explorer).

Logistician Subordinates

A majority of people will spend most, if not all, of their careers reporting to some sort of manager or other higher-ranking individual. Subordinate positions are the glue that holds organizations together,

providing the skills and support necessary to keep things running smoothly. Theirs is an important role and one that, when done well, is both satisfying and creates the possibility for career advancement. The following paragraphs will discuss what strengths and weaknesses a Logistician subordinate may face as well as techniques that will assist in rebalancing those weaknesses.

Dedicated and Loyal

There are few personality types more loyal, dedicated, meticulous, and punctual as Logisticians. They are respectful of authority and prefer their workplace to operate under a traditional hierarchy. Logisticians are patient both in terms of how they pursue their work and in how they potentially move up the career ladder. Due to their diligence, they are likely to be recognized for their hard work either through increased responsibilities, potential promotions, pay raises, or even a personal thanks or accolades.

Most importantly, their hard work often provides them with the security that they so strongly desire. Logisticians who continue to learn new skills as part of a lifelong learning process, both in their field and outside of it, make themselves even more valuable employees. Those Logisticians who are able to balance their exceptional honesty with social skills, such as empathy and optimism, will be invaluable to any employer.

Struggle with Flexibility

The dedication and commitment that make Logisticians so reliable can create other issues if imbalanced. When they become stuck in a routine, people of this type can become quite inflexible. They may be very reluctant to give up responsibilities even if it becomes apparent that another person is better suited for that task or if the workload becomes unmanageable.

Inflexibility can manifest itself in other ways as well. Logisticians need to have a clear set of instructions and well-defined responsibilities. They are likely to struggle if the expectations for their position are too vague or if they are dealing with a lot of uncertainty, revealing a strong fear of making mistakes. That fear is further compounded if they work in a

critical environment. Managers or colleagues who constantly find fault in Logisticians' work promote doubt, frustration, and dissatisfaction for Logistician subordinates.

Diligent and Resilient

Despite some of their potential struggles as subordinates, Logisticians are incredibly resilient. Perseverance is one of their greatest qualities and they work diligently to overcome any struggles they may face. One of the most effective ways to improve a difficult situation in the workplace is to take the time to sit down and have an honest conversation with their manager. Clarifying expectations and defining responsibilities are necessary in such conversations. However, it's also important to ask for honest feedback – and to listen to it openly.

Professional growth, including promotions into leadership positions, comes through both enhancing skills and addressing weaknesses. Logisticians are incredibly hard workers. However, hard work is not always enough for upward movement. Having the proper skill set, including both technical knowledge and emotional and social intelligence, is necessary to move into management positions in most companies. Logisticians looking to move beyond just being sufficient in their job need to develop these skills to be considered for a leadership position, if that's where they want to go.

Logistician Colleagues

Colleague relationships are incredibly important as many people spend a significant amount of time in the workplace around their coworkers. Positive cooperation between colleagues is necessary for a healthy and productive work environment and negative relationships can make a workplace miserable. Each personality type has different areas where they excel in these relationships as well as those where they struggle. The following paragraphs will assist Logisticians in determining what areas that make them ideal colleagues as well as those they may need to focus on improving.

Trustworthy and Honest

As colleagues, Logisticians are trustworthy, honest, and incredibly reliable. They value peace and stability and go out of their way to avoid engaging in workplace drama. In fact, Logisticians prefer to focus their attention almost entirely on work duties, ensuring that they can always be depended on to complete necessary tasks. They make an excellent addition to any team with their ability to both provide facts when brainstorming and to implement the ideas that are generated.

There are few types that work harder to ensure that things run smoothly in the workplace. Logisticians' ability to break big ideas into achievable components and the perseverance to complete any task is perhaps only rivaled by their Extraverted cousins, Executives (ESTJ). Focus is one of their greatest strengths, and while it may come at the expense of office socialization, everyone involved benefits from Logisticians' diligence and thoroughness.

Overly Structured

A desire to do everything "by the book" can lead to conflict with colleagues who are more interested in innovation. Brainstorming and theorizing without an intent to implement ideas is unacceptable to Logisticians, who see this type of behavior as wasted time and energy. Developing new ideas, when "perfectly good" ideas are already in place, is also frustrating for this type. Unless they have significant respect for a colleague, they are likely to find it difficult to acknowledge the validity of ideas that may contradict their opinions.

In addition to struggling with the uncertainty that comes from an emphasis on change and innovation, Logisticians have difficulty with building workplace relationships. They are incredibly private and see little point in networking, socializing, or small talk at work. Logisticians are incredibly reluctant to open up and unlikely to share personal information with colleagues that isn't an established and respected figure in their lives. These traits aren't negative, but they do prevent Logisticians from being able to effectively express their emotions or offer emotional support to a colleague. This can make building positive, mutually beneficial relationships with colleagues difficult for people with this personality type.

Develop Positive Relationships

Logisticians bring a great set of skills to the workplace, and those skills should be emphasized and promoted. They may not be interested in courting change, but they are a vital part of implementing changes in the workplace because of their ability to organize the fact and details. Logisticians provide the foundation necessary for both change and stability in the workplace. Realizing the importance of their role in the implementation of ideas can be used to improve their openness toward and acceptance of change.

In order to be effective employees, Logisticians will benefit from developing positive and productive relationships with their colleagues. This does not mean that they must divulge personal information about themselves. Rather they should focus on building an open line of communication beyond just being honest and factual. Specifically, Logisticians should work toward improving their empathy in order to understand the reasons behind their colleagues' desires. Asking for their coworkers' perspectives and opinions can help them to see situations from another's perspective while also giving them access to all of the facts. Finding out where their colleagues are coming from is an important step toward becoming more empathetic and understanding. Empathetic relationships make the workplace more positive as well as more productive.

Logistician Managers

Managerial roles are simultaneously some of the most challenging and rewarding roles that one can take on throughout the span of their career. The skills necessary to be a successful manager go beyond just being able to perform the tasks necessary to meet organizational goals. Truly competent managers are also well versed in social skills which allow them to interact is a positive and productive way with employees, customers, and any other relevant stakeholders. The following paragraphs will discuss areas where Logisticians truly excel as managers, as well as areas they may need to focus on improving to meet their highest potential.

Productive and Efficient

While they may prefer to work behind the scenes, Logisticians can make exceptionally productive and efficient managers as well. Few types are as effective at upholding the rules and providing structure and stability. They are willing and able to make difficult decisions and love the responsibility that comes with management positions. Devoted and reliable, individuals with this personality type often receive a great deal of respect from their subordinates.

As managers, Logisticians prefer their subordinates provide them with "Only the facts, please" and prefer objectivity over emotional pleas. They will go out of their way to avoid appearing emotional in their own communications in order to maintain the respect of their colleagues and subordinates. Far beyond just "following the rules," Logistician managers seek to act with the utmost integrity. Their word is their bond, and nothing will prevent them from meeting their commitments.

Unrealistic Expectations of Others

Logisticians hold themselves and their employees to high standards, but if unbalanced, these high expectations often become incredibly unrealistic. For example, Logisticians can become very intolerant of their subordinates' failures to meet obligations at work, especially if they believe their reasoning to be overly personal. They find it difficult to understand why others are not willing, or able, to work as diligently as they do. Logistician managers fully expect their subordinates to go above and beyond their duties – for no reason other than it is the "right thing to do."

Despite their high expectations, Logisticians are unlikely to provide any sort of praise to subordinates who do go the extra mile – because it's expected. Employees may feel that their hard work is unappreciated and that their needs for a proper work-life balance are being ignored. Discussing their personal needs with a Logistician manager is unlikely to be a positive experience, especially for sensitive subordinates. Logisticians believe the truth is more important than being empathetic, leading them to respond to subordinates in an insensitive way.

Improve Interactions and Expectations

Management positions require a unique set of skills and well-rounded development. To become the best managers they can be, Logisticians need to focus on balancing out their weaknesses, specifically their expectations and social skills. They may be incredibly proficient at the logistical aspects of their job, but if they are unable to communicate effectively with subordinates or clients, they can find themselves miserable at the very least.

It is necessary for Logistician managers to ensure that their expectations of their subordinates are realistic and not just based on their personal beliefs about work ethic and efficiency. Working with a colleague who can provide Logisticians with objective feedback on their expectations is ideal. A Human Resources manager or Professional Development colleague would likely be able to provide some much-needed perspective and advice. Sharing expectations with employees, both individually and in groups, is important as well and will help ensure that everyone is on the same page and allow employees to bring up ideas and concerns as well. Providing adequate recognition for the work being done, by doing thoughtful things such as bringing in donuts every week or personally acknowledging individual accomplishments, will go a long way to promote good will with subordinates.

Finally, Logisticians who are managers (or are interested in becoming a manager) should seek out opportunities to improve their social skills. The importance of being proficient in these skills should not be underestimated for current or future managers of any personality type.

The next section will provide further information and opportunities to exercise these specific skills in the workplace.

Workplace Cooperation Between Roles

Understanding how Logisticians tend to behave in various hierarchical roles is one thing – communicating their plans to subordinates, colleagues, and managers effectively, and seeing those processes to completion as a team is another. Now, we dig a little deeper to determine how Logisticians can best cooperate with their coworkers.

Logistician-Analyst Cooperation

Balanced Logistician-Analyst Cooperation

Efficient and Effective

Logisticians' and Analysts' most powerful shared quality is the need for efficiency in the workplace. Logisticians work to bring order to an organization with perhaps more mundane, but nevertheless necessary, matters. Analysts, on the other hand, work with systems to try to optimize every second. Each plays a different role when they have a job that suits them in an organization.

The Logistician and Analyst relationship is a mutually beneficial one, with Logisticians providing reality checks, then organizing and implementing the visions, ideas, and plans that Analysts develop, if they pass the analysis for pragmatic improvement. Logisticians are great at getting things done but tend not to see the value of letting their minds wander down the myriad of pathways needed to brainstorm a new process. Analysts may be masters at manipulating ideas, but they need someone else around to turn their ideas into something achievable. In many ways, they are a perfect match, with Analysts accelerating this improvement and Logisticians ensuring that the acceleration is controlled and useful.

From such examples, one might easily think that Logisticians are always subordinate to visionary Analysts. However, when considering an Analyst in a research position with a Logistician boss, there is the opposite power relationship. Yet they complement each other just the same. Regardless of their workplace roles, by clearly understanding and accepting one another's role and communicating from their positions of strength, each type can become invaluable to the other.

Analysts and Logisticians can create a mutually useful and productive partnership in the workplace.

Improving Attitudes

Logisticians are a modest type, and many Analysts could stand to take a page or two from their book on how to be humble. Analysts will come to respect (and hopefully try to emulate) the competence and modesty of their Logistician colleagues. While they appreciate accolades, Logisticians do not work to actively seek it out. Where Analysts may intentionally pursue opportunities to flaunt their knowledge, their humble Logistician colleagues prefer to work for quality over attention. This is a trait that many Analysts can benefit from improving, and Logisticians are more than happy to assist them.

Logisticians, on the other hand, can get stuck in a relatively narrow way of thinking at times. Things are either right or wrong, black or white, and not necessarily open to new interpretations. Analysts are an excellent example of thinking outside of the box and viewing challenges as opportunities. In the workplace, they can encourage and inspire their Logistician colleagues to think of different options or a unique approach that they wouldn't have previously considered.

Unbalanced Logistician-Analyst Cooperation

Maintaining versus Innovating

There's an old saying: "Nobody likes change except a wet baby." Whole industries have grown up around "change management." But it's not true that nobody appreciates change. Intuitive types like Analysts love change. They always look for ideas that improve things. On some level, these types crave it as it represents growth and possibilities to them.

On the other hand, Logisticians focus more on doing the right thing according to established and proven standards. There is an inherent fear of change for Logisticians, stemming from the instability found within unfamiliar situations or circumstances. Big changes carry big risks, and this type of uncertainty does not bode well for stability-craving Logisticians, which is not necessarily an illegitimate fear. They aren't likely to aggressively oppose an Analyst who is pushing their

innovative ideas. However, this fear may make it may be difficult for them to support any ideas that are not backed up by sufficient evidence for their potential success. This may frustrate Analysts, who may view the lack of support as an inability to see "the big picture" or even as "simple-minded" stubbornness, an unfair assessment in the least.

Struggle with Social Intelligence

Social intelligence, including skills such as empathy, active listening, conversational skills, and an understanding of social roles and norms, is something that both Logisticians and Analysts struggle with. Both have a social style that can lack warmth and the consideration for the emotional needs of others. Logisticians are more concerned with communicating information efficiently and truthfully than in a sensitive manner while Analysts are often more interested in making their point than interacting in an empathetic manner.

The Thinking trait that these types share makes them effective, but not compassionate, colleagues. They may communicate efficiently with each other, but their interactions with other coworkers, especially those with the Feeling trait, is likely to be much more contentious. When both Logisticians and Analysts are part of a workplace team, they may have a tendency to bulldoze their more sensitive, less confrontational colleagues. While their focus on facts and efficiency make them wonderfully productive employees, their insensitive natures can make them incredibly difficult to work with.

Rebalancing Logistician-Analyst Cooperation

Getting Results

At the end of the day, both Logisticians and Analysts value results above just about anything else – they just have very different approaches and skill sets when it comes to achieving those results. Logisticians will likely come to respect Analysts for their hard work, while Analysts will appreciate Logisticians' frank analysis of a situation, as long as it seems like it's an effort to improve the idea, not an unconsidered dismissal.

Instead of focusing on their fears or frustrations, both types should practice looking at the other as having the skills necessary

to counterbalance their own abilities. Logisticians are masters at implementation, while Analysts have a multitude of ideas in need of someone to help with their execution. Additionally, the stability that Logisticians provide within the sea of change constantly swirling around their Analyst colleagues is truly invaluable. The ideas that Analysts bring forward are geared toward improving processes and achieving results more efficiently, and there is little that Logisticians value more than an operation that runs smoothly. Each type will benefit from the strengths and skills that the other brings to the workplace, and the entire organization will benefit from them as well.

Practice Empathetic Interactions

Fortunately for both of these types, social skills can be improved through hard work and practice. Logisticians prefer to maintain peace and stability in the workplace, and learning to communicate in a sensitive and understanding way will go a long way toward making this possible. The more positive interactions that they can engage in, the more peaceful and productive their environment will become.

The most important social skills that can be practiced to improve communication in the workplace is empathy. Empathy is the ability to see where someone else is coming from and understand why they feel the way they do. The best way to improve empathy is to simply ask questions. If a coworker seems especially frustrated, asking them why they are frustrated can result in a significant amount of information. Perhaps they have been struggling with juggling work and family obligations.

Rather than judging their situation, Logisticians can practice observing how those situations affect their Analyst colleague. They may not struggle with balancing family and work obligations, but they cannot assume that their circumstances are identical to their coworkers'. Their colleague may be working an additional job for extra income, have ailing parents they are also taking care of, or perhaps they are a single parent with a limited support network. It's easy to judge someone when their circumstances are unknown, but being empathic teaches us to look beyond preconceived notions and attempt to understand where others are coming from.

Logistician-Diplomat Cooperation

Balanced Logistician-Diplomat Cooperation

Taking Care of Others

Both Logisticians and Diplomats like to take care of other people, albeit in very different ways, and are likely to have similar goals when it comes to improving the workplace. While Diplomats focus more on ideological matters of compassion and professional growth, Logisticians' interests lie more in assisting others on a more practical level. For example, Logisticians will make sure that they complete the payroll so everyone receives their pay. Meanwhile, Diplomats might focus on making sure that everyone receives fair treatment and that they genuinely benefit from professional development. Both find energy and self-respect in doing good for others, and there is plenty of common ground on which to bond in that area.

Macro and Micro Visions

Logisticians and Diplomats complement each other by providing different kinds of support for the organization. For Diplomats, they focus on the larger picture and the big ideas that are important, specifically personal and professional growth for both themselves and others. Logisticians are also interested in doing what's best for individuals, however, they believe that this is most effectively done by achieving organizational goals. Together, these two types will push workplace options that will provide support both in terms of professional growth and in meeting practical needs such as health-care benefits and time-off policies.

Partnering with a Diplomat can help Logisticians to hold onto the greater vision of an organization, especially around issues about

human capital. Logisticians, for their part, can ensure that all of the necessary details are being considered and ensure that plans are carried out practically and efficiently. They can help to ground the plans that Diplomats put forward (like flexible hours, benefits, on-site child care, and so on) with much needed pragmatism. Both types find balance and benefit from drawing on each other's sometimes dramatically divergent perspectives – they ultimately have the shared goal of making the workplace somewhere where everyone thrives.

Unbalanced Logistician-Diplomat Cooperation

Realistic versus Idealistic

To Logisticians, Diplomats may appear to pursue actions or ideas on a whim without considering consequences or logistics. They do not realize the subconscious linking of information or feelings that has taken place to lead them to their decisions. Logisticians, on the other hand, may come across to their Diplomat colleagues as overly focused on the details and unwilling to consider the "big picture."

Conflict arises between Logisticians and Diplomats when there is an opinion that one is too pragmatic (Logisticians) or the other is too idealistic (Diplomats). If one arrives 10 minutes early for work and another arrives 10 minutes late, you can almost guess which one is the Logistician and which is the Diplomat. It won't be because Diplomats thumb their noses at the rules or time clocks. It's just that those 10 minutes are not as important to them on their mental list of priorities. However, that might be hard to explain to a Logistician supervisor who finds comfort in enforcing the rules. It can become difficult to bridge this gap in attitudes and behaviors.

Personal Growth or Practical Needs?

While both Logisticians and Diplomats want what's best for their organization, they may have very different ideas about what that means. Logisticians believe that "what's best" is for the organization to run smoothly, consistently, and efficiently. Anything that interrupts the reliability of the workflow is unnecessary and to be avoided at all costs. Diplomats, on the other hand, believe that focusing on the

development of the individuals within the organization is worth much more than an efficient organizational structure. These divergent views can cause conflict when either type believes that their view of what the workplace should provide is the "correct" or more noble view.

Imagine a meeting where members of a company are discussing their budget needs for the upcoming year. Logisticians will present budget needs in terms of cost needed to keep the company running such as overhead expenses, payroll, and capital expenditures. A Diplomat colleague may inquire about adjusting the budget to include professional development opportunities for employees as well. Unless it is blatantly obvious that such opportunities would benefit the overall company as opposed to only the employees that partake in them, Logisticians are unlikely to see the value or consider altering the budget to include them.

Rebalancing Logistician-Diplomat Cooperation

Find Shared Objectives

The good thing about Logisticians and Diplomats is that they both prefer to reduce conflict in the workplace and interact in a positive and productive way. In that sense, Logisticians can expect their Diplomat colleagues to willingly participate in any rebalancing efforts when tensions rise. Specifically, Logisticians can work on connecting with Diplomats with a focus on their positive intentions. Finding shared values, such as promoting the well-being of the company or fighting for a client who needs their help, will be more effective than trying to get them on board with following the "rules."

Practicing patience and focusing on what objectives they have in common is always good advice and will certainly improve communication and cooperation. Logisticians will usually find their Diplomat colleagues willing to discuss ways to work together in more positive and efficient ways. If they explain their thoughts about a specific idea in a sensitive and understanding way, Diplomats will likely make every effort to provide them with as many facts and details as possible. Logisticians can ask questions about specific details, such as who will do the work, how long the work will take, and what will happen to other deadlines

and priorities of people who are pulled from existing work. These questions can call attention to the level of planning that is necessary to complete the tasks without resulting in unnecessary confrontation.

Logisticians can also benefit from knowing that their Diplomat coworkers benefit from the stability and attention to detail that they provide. Diplomats are not always detail-oriented and may not even realize the amount of work that goes into completing certain tasks. Knowing how dependable and helpful they are, Diplomats will likely seek out Logistician colleagues to help them determine the best way to go about implementing their ideas. These personality types will find that they can resolve any potential problems by understanding that both of their world views (and skill sets) have something valuable to offer.

Engage in Mutual Encouragement

Despite their different beliefs on specific workplace priorities, Logisticians and Diplomats are appreciative of anyone who is looking to improve conditions for everyone. In a world where there is such an extreme focus on profits, productivity, power there doesn't seem to be as much concern about the people being affected by these systems. Working together, these types can improve the workplace for themselves as well as for others.

Both Diplomats and Logisticians can benefit from focusing on encouraging each other and supporting the work that they do. Logisticians, in their focus on practical needs, may find that asking Diplomats deeper questions about their ideas can help them to ensure that the practical aspects are being covered. Having a realistic timeline, adequate funding, and a manageable workload may all be considerations that are obvious to Logisticians but potentially overlooked by Diplomats. Similarly, Logisticians can benefit from listening to the creative, thoughtful components of their Diplomat colleagues' ideas. What may seem idealistic to some will likely have at least some value for an organization, and Logisticians can help their Diplomat colleagues determine what is realistic and how to implement it.

Logistician-Sentinel Cooperation

Balanced Logistician-Sentinel Cooperation

Pragmatic and Truthful

Logisticians are pragmatists, and when working with Sentinel coworkers they can avoid some of the issues that they may face with less practical colleagues. Their interactions with Sentinel coworkers will likely be less trying than those with Analysts who are constantly trying to reorganize already effective processes. They will also be less frustrating than dealing with Diplomat colleagues who are more concerned with addressing workplace issues than adhering to deadlines.

Though it may seem like an insensitive way to function, Logisticians' pragmatic nature actually comes from a place of concern for others. Sentinels are nurturers in the sense that they want to take care of other people, and Logisticians display this by performing tasks to the best of their ability. They try to make others' lives easier through attention to detail, completed actions, and satisfying outcomes for all individuals involved. Both Logisticians and their Sentinel colleagues will want to make sure that they consider every possibility toward that end.

Unbalanced Logistician-Sentinel Cooperation

Different Styles

Despite their similarities, Logisticians may find themselves disagreeing with Sentinel colleagues who differ in their approaches. For example, while Executives and Logisticians are both data-driven and incredibly focused, Logisticians may be put off by Executives' overtly aggressive

approach. Consuls, who are very involved, can come across as invasive to very private Logisticians who prefer to be left alone rather than interact with others.

Logisticians are focused on doing their job efficiently and effectively, and their communication style reflects that focus. Where their Defender and Consul colleagues may focus on ensuring that everyone is taken care of, Logisticians consider sensitivity less important than making sure that the information communicates an effective assessment or process. This can lead to issues with other Sentinels who may believe that Logisticians' approach is cold-hearted or insensitive.

Stuck in Their Ways

The challenges Logisticians may have when working with other Sentinels will most likely have nothing to do with whether or not they understand each other. However, they may have trouble if they become stuck in their own style of thinking without the benefit of insight from those who think differently. In business and in life, it's good to have varied personality type around to provide balance and promote inclusivity.

Discussions of innovation and change, if extensive enough, may also be unsettling for Logisticians and their Sentinel colleagues. They connect with the traditional ways of doing things. Sentinels bear their name for a reason. They protect what which they value in that important role, they take care of others, and they have a fixed way of doing things. They serve as the anchors needed in a stable society. However, the world is a rapidly changing place and often organizations need to innovate to compete. "Thinking out of the box" is an overused cliché that shows through its overuse how important thinking in new ways has become.

For Sentinels, a challenge to the confines of the proverbial box may feel almost like an affront. They have probably spent a lot of time protecting systems that work and may get uncomfortable when they feel those systems are threatened. Sentinels should be aware of these traits and invite other personality types to the table when the topic necessarily turns to developing new products or systems.

Rebalancing Logistician-Sentinel Cooperation

Focus on Common Ground

Despite differences in their approaches, Logisticians find cooperation with other Sentinels easier when they focus on their common goals. While they are not an especially empathetic personality type, Logisticians nevertheless prefer harmony in the workplace. Getting their work done efficiently and effectively is much easier when everyone is getting along and working together. Embracing some of the traits that their Defender and Consul colleagues model, especially their sensitivity toward others, can help improve their workplace relationships.

The underlying motivation for all Sentinels, Feeling and Thinking types alike, is to support society. They desire cooperation and work diligently to develop their character. However, there is a tendency for Logisticians especially, to allow protocol and procedure to overshadow the human component of the workplace. They can remedy this by reorienting the goals that they look at, such as adjusting a schedule to provide flexibility which can increase overall productivity and employee morale. This way, they can consider the needs of colleagues, customers, and the company in addition to the logistical needs. If they are approaching an issue from a place of caring and cooperation, they will find that the factual data they provide is better received by their Sentinel colleagues.

Share the Load

Much can be said for having allies in the workplace, especially those who may share some of the same views and behaviors. It's especially important for Logisticians to find some like-minded colleagues that they can trust and "share the load" with, as Sentinel Samwise Gamgee from Tolkien's *The Lord of the Rings* would say. Fellow Sentinels are both dependable and likely to share their desire to get things done properly. This combination of traits makes them the perfect colleagues to assist with a heavy workload.

Logisticians, like many Sentinels, often believe that they are best equipped to do the work that falls within their jurisdiction. Realistically, there are likely others who can do the work equally as well and are just as interested in doing quality work efficiently and effectively. It's important for Logisticians to understand that their ultimate goals are

probably the same as others, especially other Sentinels. Letting go of the need to have control can be difficult, but when the workload is overwhelming, or there is someone else who may be better suited to a certain task, Logisticians will find that releasing these tasks is a better use of their time.

Logistician-Explorer Cooperation

Balanced Logistician-Explorer Cooperation

Practical and Tangible

It's easy to get the impression that Logisticians and Explorers are complete opposites. While they often approach things differently, both types gather their information from the world around them rather than from a more internal, intuitive source like Analysts and Diplomats do. However, that's where most of their likenesses end. While Explorers are more in touch with things directly and immediately, Logisticians usually filter their experiences through an organized thought process with consideration for both consequences and compliance with the rules. Explorers relish the new and exciting, while Logisticians favor the safe and stable. Despite these differences, they both speak in terms of what is practical and tangible, as opposed to the more ambiguous or abstract dialogue favored by Intuitive types.

Logisticians and Explorers most often complement each other when things go wrong. Sometimes even the tried-and-true ways of doing things fail. This can be disconcerting to Logisticians, but for Explorers, it's a compelling problem to solve. In this ever-changing world, there are often times when the old methods no longer work. There may be no other choice than to develop a new way of doing things, and

Explorers' hands-on, solution-oriented approach can help Logisticians make sense of many new or challenging situations.

A Reliable Home Base for Explorative Types

On the other hand, sometimes Explorers' impulsive drive to find solutions can get off track. Sometimes, the best answer when a situation goes bad is to retreat to a known starting place. "Known places" are where Logisticians like to spend their time. Sometimes, as Explorers get older, they seek out Sentinel marriage partners to help them settle down. While this makes sense, it also makes sense that it could apply to professional situations.

There are times when boldly "winging it" can lead to effective solutions. However, there are also times when such approaches create more problems than they solve. Sometimes a Logistician can help an Explorer "come home," figuratively speaking. Logisticians usually know how to repair a situation, or they know someone who does. This can be of great help to an Explorer who has wandered too far in the wrong direction.

Unbalanced Logistician-Explorer Cooperation

Differences in Discipline

Explorers have no problem cutting corners when they feel it is necessary, while Logisticians usually dedicate their lives to making sure that those corners remain intact just the way they were made. Explorers tend to have a freer attitude and love things that are new and interesting. For example, Logisticians may have a favorite restaurant they go to most of the time, while Explorers will want to sample all the latest restaurants that open in town.

Entrepreneurs (ESTPs), with their loose ethics and brazen focus on action over substance, are particularly likely to frustrate and offend morally conscious Logisticians. Actions, are symbolic of beliefs, and Logisticians believe in fairness for all people. For Explorers, especially Entrepreneurs, actions are largely based on their individual, often spontaneous, desires. They aren't necessarily uncaring toward others, but fairness may be viewed by these types as weakness or a lack of ability to protect or promote their own interests and well-being. This

isn't true of all Explorers, especially those with the Feeling trait, who are much less likely to focus on this type self-promotion.

Stability Meets Spontaneity

While stability seems essential to Logisticians, Explorers will have no problem doing whatever they need to do to solve a problem regardless of "how it's always been done." Logisticians see the tried-and-true means as the way to a guaranteed end. Only the end concerns Explorers and they may use any means necessary to get there. For them, it doesn't have to follow traditional protocol.

It's easy to see how Logisticians can view Explorers as being at cross-purposes with them. Logisticians may devote an undue amount of time trying to get Explorers to walk in a straight line according to the rules. Meanwhile, Explorers may ignore Logisticians as they do whatever they feel they must do, going in a straight line or serpentine, to master a situation. The possibilities for conflicts are endless.

Rebalancing Logistician-Explorer Cooperation

Embrace and Appreciate Differences

Improving cooperation between Logisticians and Explorers is the ultimate balancing act. Logisticians, for their part, will have to learn to embrace the idea that each personality type brings their own unique set of skills and abilities to the workplace. Explorers can be a strong asset in the workplace, and while everyone needs to follow the rules, constantly playing the role of "rules police" may be more trouble than it's worth if Explorers are contributing in positive ways. In the same vein, a little acknowledgment can go a long way with Explorers, and Logisticians should make sure that they show appreciation for the good things that Explorers do. Explorers are likely to reciprocate this by acknowledging the good work that Logisticians do as well.

As colleagues or managers working with Explorers, Logisticians will find the most effective approach is to outline specific expectations, objectives, and timelines and allow Explorers to work from there. Micromanaging will not be effective with these independent types,

and Logisticians will find it easier to step back and let their Explorer colleagues pursue the outlined objectives in the way that works best for them.

Provide Stability... But Also, Live a Little

Logisticians' ability to provide stability is especially important for Explorers, as they are the most likely to get off track and give into their impulses. While they may initially find their Logistician colleagues' reliability boring or unnecessary, Explorers will likely come to appreciate (and rely on) it when they have ventured too far off course. The dependability and support that Logisticians provide is vital for any workplace, but especially so when there are Explorers in the company as well.

At the same time, much can be said for adventuring outside of one's comfort zone. Most growth, both professional and personal, comes from difficult or unique experiences. Logisticians who want to grow would do well to seek out an Explorer to help them test their boundaries. Volunteering for a project that they wouldn't normally become involved in, partnering with an Explorer on a task that they would normally do themselves, or even just seeking out advice or a new perspective from an Explorer colleague can provide valuable insight and promote positive cooperation.

Conclusion

Expanded Structure

Logisticians might just be the masters of structure, and this often benefits their professional lives. It isn't usually a problem for them to develop their dedication, efficiency, and conscientiousness to the point of irreproachability – something that most employers value. And yet, as this dutiful type creates the structures that serve them, they can also take care not to brick themselves in, trading prosperity for security and predictability. If there's ever a type to become satisfied in a groove, it's Logisticians. If that groove is a steady track to advancement, so much the better, but if it's a rut, this type may need to muster some force to get themselves moving forward again.

A love of structure can support a wonderful career, if that structure is built – and occasionally modified – to include diverse elements and abilities. When Logisticians' tendencies and preferences are utilized as productive methods rather than as boundaries, they serve them very well. Areas of potential improvement for this type discussed above, such as social intelligence, are merely unfamiliar systems to figure out, practice, and incorporate into a personally beneficial structure for their professional lives. The key for this type is to raise their eyes from the task at hand now and then, and dare to ask what could be better. Logisticians who are willing to expand their view rarely find any limits in life.

Final Words

Logisticians are known for being responsible and reliable, making them model students and star employees. They commit themselves to going above and beyond, always taking their educational and professional duties seriously. They also see their careers not as a domain for fun and experimentation but as a space where they can contribute to society and uphold traditions. In this way, Logisticians resist chasing personal desires in their studies and the jobs that they pursue. Instead, they prioritize the needs and expectations of those around them.

But neglecting personal fulfillment can generate some negative consequences for people with this personality type. Logisticians may feel burdened by perfectionistic standards, and work may become an area of obligation rather than growth or enjoyment. They may also shy away from change or novelty, sticking to the safe and practical paths that have already been paved by those who came before them. But, sometimes, the road less traveled can lead to greatness, *if* Logisticians choose to explore it.

They may also struggle when their role isn't clearly defined, whether in a group project for school or a work meeting. Logisticians who are used to being managed by others may stumble when given autonomy. And when forming new groups or teams, collaboration may not come naturally to Logisticians, who tend to overlook people skills. However, when people with this personality type branch out, they usually find a way to win over their peers with their hard work and dedication.

Our hope is that these pages have affirmed the strengths that Logisticians offer the world through their studies and professional endeavors, while also providing tools to manage the challenges that they may face. By finding their own career path, balancing pragmatism with flexibility, and practicing their social skills at school and work, Logisticians can find long-term fulfillment in their academic and professional careers.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want more tests and insights to help you excel in your career? Explore our Career Specialized Tests.
- Looking to enhance your relationships? Check out the *Logistician Guide to Relationships*.
- Ready to build a strong foundation for your self-development? Our *Logistician Guide to Personal Growth* may be just what you need.

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